

New Red Manager?

Crosley "at Sea"

BY HARRY MAYO

Powel Crosley Jr. is as much at sea as anyone else on a successor to Birdie Tebbetts, former Redlegs' manager. Or so he told The Post and Times-Star in his first interview since Birdie quit.

Owner Crosley was literally at sea when the interview took place. He was en route to Seattle from Alaska on the yacht *Principia*, and was reached by marine radio-telephone. He will arrive here Wednesday.

"I DON'T KNOW who the new manager will be and can't comment until I have talked with Gabe Paul," he said. (General Manager Paul later phoned Mr. Crosley on the yacht but said nothing specific was mentioned because ship-to-shore calls are carried on public airwaves.)

"I've been away so long I'm in no position to say anything until the future clarifies itself. When Birdie quit, Gabe sent word through our Seattle club. That's all I know so far—except that the Redlegs have lost a lot of games. I've been following them by radio."

Mr. Crosley said he "has no idea" why Tebbetts quit.

"BUT I SUPPOSE he had his own reasons," the club owner added. "I am very fond of Birdie and it is regretta-

ble that things did not turn out right."

Mr. Crosley left July 23 on a cruise that took him to Juneau, Alaska. The yacht, owned by a friend, is due to dock in Seattle Tuesday. Mr. Crosley will board a plane Tuesday night and arrive in Cincinnati Wednesday morning. Mr. Paul expects to talk managerial possibilities then.

THESE TALKS apparently will range over a number of possibilities. Mr. Crosley indicated as much when The Post and Times-Star told him several names which had been mentioned.

"I really can't tell," he said. "Gabe and I have to talk."

A Manager From the Minors?

BY BOB PILLE

The minor leagues could produce the new Red manager, and it won't necessarily be a man who has been around before as a big league skipper.

Gabe Paul's requirement is "managerial experience." But he emphasizes that this could be in the minors as well as the majors.

That leaves a mixture of qualifiers bouncing around the lesser leagues after you get past two who are down there recovering from recent firings.



Bob Pille

Bobby Bragan is at Spokane after getting the double bounce from the Pirates and Indians, and Kerby Farrell is at Miami after also feeling the application of the Cleveland boot.

Farrell isn't a Cincinnati possibility. Bragan is a colorful citizen, but the faithful might be tough to sell on a man twice fired in two summers.

One of the best minor league bets is practically in the Reds' back yard: Clyde King at Columbus. A pitcher in Cincinnati for

part of the 1953 season, King is well regarded among baseball men. He's a serious student of the managing trade, quit hurling to pursue it when the first opportunity appeared, and has generally been considered the heir apparent in the Pittsburgh organization.

King has done well at Atlanta and Hollywood and has Columbus striking for first division.

In the International league, too, are old outfielder Dixie Walker at Toronto, old pitcher Clay Bryant at Montreal, and old pitcher Ed Lopat at Richmond.

The American Association has another in the crown prince class — Omaha's veteran Johnny Keane in the Cardinal organization.

Denver's Andy Cohen has been around a long time, but

Indianapolis' Walker Cooper would fall shy of Gabe's requirements since this is his first managing season. Birdie Tebbetts bounced up from Indianapolis after only one year, but he was an exceptional case.



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